Rs 388 crores was sanctioned for this purpose. Thus was born India's prestigious Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme, later abbreviated to IGMDP. When I presented the government sanction letter before the Missile Technology Committee at DRDL, they were enthused with fire and action. The proposed projects were christened in accordance with the spirit of India's self-reliance. Thus the Surface-to-Surface weapon system became Prithvi ("the Earth") and the Tactical Core Vehicle was cal ed Trishul (the trident of Lord Shiva). The Surface-to-Air area defence system was named as Akash ("sky") and the anti-tank missile project Nag ("Cobra"). I gave the name Agni ("Fire") to my long cherished dream of REX. Dr Arunachalam came to DRDL and formal y launched the IGMDP on 27 July 1983. It was a great event in which every single employee of DRDL participated. Everybody who was somebody in Indian Aerospace Research was invited. A large number of scientists from other laboratories and organizations, professors from academic institutions, representatives of the armed forces, production centres, and inspection authorities, who were our business partners now, were present on this occasion. A closed-circuit TV